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Q- How did the abolition of East India Company's trade monopoly under the Charter Acts of 1813 & 1833 accelerated India's transformation from a commercial outpost to a full-fledged colony?

Ans The Charter Acts of 1813 and 1833 marked a significant turning point by abolishing East India Company's (EIC) exclusive trade monopoly. These acts became an instrument of imperial governance.

① Centralisation of Political Power —

The Charter Act of 1833 centralised political authority in the hands of Governor General of India ensuring that India was governed as a single unified entity. This made it easier for the British to implement imperial policies throughout

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the subcontinent. It laid the structural foundation of British rule

② Economic Integration And Exploitation —

↳ Charter Acts of 1813 and 1833 ended the trade monopoly of EIC.

↳ Now, the British private merchants and traders entered the Indian market giving competition to local industries.

↳ It led to deindustrialisation and made India dependent on British goods.

↳ India's role shifted from a trading partner to a colony exploited for resources.

③ Cultural Subjugation —

↳ Charter Act of 1813 permitted the entry of Christian missionaries and spread of English education marking the beginning of British

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cultural influence.

↳ It led to class of people who are Indian in blood and race but British in taste and intellect leading to erosion of traditional system and values

↳ This cultural subjugation further strengthened the colonial legacy

④ Legal control —

↳ The Charter Act of 1833 established Law Commission which codified the laws leading to uniform imperial legal framework.

⑤ Infrastructure —

The Britishers built railways, ports, telegraph not for Indian benefit but efficient mobilisation of troops during uprising and to

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ensure smooth trade. These
networks made India a colonial
structure.

These acts institutionalised colonial
rule by shifting the company
from trade to administration,
paving the way for British
Crown's takeover after 1858.

This transition made India a
British colony deepening the
exploitation.